

BCPS Centenary review

By C.G.S.Narayanan

The oldest existing chess problem society, the BCPS (British Chess Problem Society) has turned hundred with international membership. Its Centenary Review brought out by British IM for chess composition Barry P. Barnes and IM for solving Michael McDowell presented activities of the society which promoted problem composition and solving during the period 1918-2018. In this review 463 prize winning problems and endgame studies by British and commonwealth composers show an astonishing variety of chess almost never seen in the game-the poetry of chess. Here I present three prize winners which incidentally won Brian Harley Awards as well.

R.C.O.Mathews
I prize,BCF Ty 72



Mate in three moves

Key 1.Qb5!(2.Rf3+Ke4 3.d3)
1...Rc5 2.Rd6+ Ng6 3.Rfxd4
1..Bc5 2.Re6+ Ng6 3.Qxc4
1...Rd5 2.Rc6+ Ng6 3.Qxc5
1...Bd5 2.Rb6+ Ng6 3.Rxd4
1..Qf6 2.Rh6+ Bg6 3.Rh3

The organ pipes placing of the bRs and bBs has them doubly guarding c4 and d4. In response to the threat bRs and bBs close the WQ line of guard to make e5 a prospective

flight square but each defence at c5 and d5 cuts one line of guard. Discovered checks from the B+R battery arrive to close second line of guard for mates on c4 and d4.

W.A.Whyatt

I prize,The Problemist 1959



Mate in three moves

Key 1.Qe1!(Bxc2+ Rxc2 3.Qe4)
1..Rdx1 2.Kb8 (3.Nxd4/Ne7)
1...Be3 2.Kxb7 (3.Ne7) 1..Nxd6
2.Kxd6 (3.Ne7)2..Rxe5 3.Qxe5

The down under key to put the WQ doubly en prise is a wonderful surprise for solvers but the further surprise is the trio of WK moves to unpin WNC6.

Problem below (for solving) by FIDE master shows correction play on d4.

M.Parthasarathy

I prize,The Problemist 1963



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'An unsung classic revisited':
1.h3? waiting 1...fxg5/Kh4
2.Qh7/Qg4 but 1...Kh6! 1.h4? waiting
1...fxg5/Kh6 2.Qxg5/Qh7 but
1...Kxh4! Try 1.Kf8? waiting
1...Kh6/Kh4 2.Nf7/Nf3 but
1...fxg5!Key 1.Kf7! waiting
1...Kh6/Kh4/fxg5 2.Qg6/Nf3/Qh3

Readers may send in their queries to
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